Khanh Duong (Kevin)

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Google Scholar GitHub ORCID

Research interests: Equality of Opportunity, Intergenerational Inequality, Social Norms

Education

University of Turku, Finland (employed) *Jan 2026 – Now*
PhD Inequalities, Interventions and New Welfare State (DPInvest)

- Supervisors: Prof. Jani Erola, Dr. Hannu Lehti
- Dissertation: The institutional roots of intergenerational persistence
- Employed by INVEST Research Flagship Centre

Maastricht University, the Netherlands (with fellowship) *Sep 2024 – Sep 2026*
PhD Innovation, Economics, Governance, and Sustainable Development

- Supervisors: Prof. Wim Groot (Maastricht) and Prof. Kristof De Witte (KU Leuven)
- Research fellowship with United Nations University – MERIT
- Dissertation: The role of familial relationships in intergenerational inequality in education

Maynooth University, Ireland (with grant) *Sep 2021 – Sep 2023*
Master by Research in Sociology

- Supervisors: Dr. Eoin Flaherty, Prof. Seán Ó Riain
- Fully funded by the Irish Research Council under award number GOIPG/2021/441
- Thesis: The Roles of Poverty and Inequality as Factors in the Impact of Climate Change
- Publication in Economic Change and Restructuring

Foreign Trade University, HCMC Campus, Vietnam *Sep 2012 – Apr 2016*
Bachelor of International Business Economics

- GPA of 81.1%, high marks in Advanced Mathematics and Business Analytics
- Thesis: The impact of trade openness on the unemployment rate of Vietnam
- Third Prize at the HCM City-level Competition on Effective University Learning Methods

Selected presentations

ECSR-CA-NASP Joint Spring School at Collegio Carlo Alberto *Turin, Italy*
What Should Perfect Mobility Look Like? *Mar 2026*

- Discussant: Prof. Fabrizio Bernardi (UNED, Madrid)
- Highly selected via a competitive international application process

Selected publications

2025 If inequality is an economic choice, what is the relationship between inequality and growth?
Single-authored in **Structural Change and Economic Dynamics**
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.strueco.2025.02.014
Notes: Multiobjective optimization algorithms in operations research

2024 What really matters for global intergenerational mobility?
Single-authored in **PLOS ONE**
https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0302173
Notes: Media coverage by EurekAlert and Mirage News

2024 Is meritocracy just? New evidence from Boolean analysis and machine learning
Single-authored in **Journal of Computational Social Science**
https://doi.org/10.1007/s42001-024-00287-2
Notes: Novel approach with true–false logic (in philosophy) and causal machine learning

2023 Does growth reduce poverty? The mediating role of carbon emissions and income inequality
Lead-authored (with my supervisor) in **Economic Change and Restructuring**
https://doi.org/10.1007/s10644-022-09462-9
Notes: From my research master's thesis using generalized method of moments

Working papers

- How Strong Are Fairness Norms Across EU Countries? (conditionally accepted at Acta Psychologica)
- Correcting Bias in Estimating the Intergenerational Transmission of Education: The Role of Gene-Environment Interplay
- What Should Perfect Mobility Look Like? Fair Progress in the Intergenerational Mobility Table
- When the Apple Falls Fairly: A Methodological Review of Intergenerational Transmission
- Beyond GDP: Culture and National Happiness

Honors and awards

Research Fellowship *Sep 2024*
United Nations University – MERIT, Maastricht, Netherlands

- Project: Advancing the study of socio-economic inequality: A new analytical approach
- Supervisors: Prof. Wim Groot (Maastricht University) and Prof. Kristof De Witte (KU Leuven)

Government of Ireland Postgraduate Research Scholarship *Sep 2021*
Irish Research Council, Ireland

- Project: The impact of globalization on the unemployment rate in the Asia-Pacific region
- Funding amount: €55,000.00 for two years of master's degree

Homeworks Summer Climate Action Residency *Jun 2023*
Community Climate Action Programme

- Hosted by The Common Knowledge Centre in The Burren, County Clare, Ireland
- Co-created a toolkit designed to facilitate climate action at the household level.

Experience

Generative AI data annotator (full-time) *Dublin, Ireland*
Covalen (on-site at Meta) *Feb 2024 – Sep 2024*

- Annotated English data accurately per guidelines, processing 100+ tickets daily.
- Evaluated data quality and machine learning outputs.
- Maintained annotation guidelines and attended 1–2 training sessions weekly.

Research Executive (full-time) *HCMC, Vietnam*
Indochina Research *Mar 2021 – Sep 2021*

- Led the TRAFFIC project (wildlife animal products in Vietnam) N = 600
- Monitored the WHO project (COVID-awareness in Vietnam) N = 1500
- Designed and scripted questionnaires by Survey-Togo (a survey Platform)
- Conducted data analysis with SPSS & STATA, and Q-research
- Wrote final reports and described research methodologies

Research Officer (part-time) *HCMC, Vietnam*
UEH Institute of Business Research *Nov 2020 – Sep 2021*

- Published a peer-reviewed book chapter in Springer, Singapore.
- Completed two working papers on sustainable development
- Drafted one national research funding application.

Import-Export Executive (full-time) *An Giang, Vietnam*
Nam Viet Corporation *Aug 2018 – Oct 2020*

- Completed customs procedure to +50 countries with 300+ containers/ month
- Drafted 100+ sale contracts/ months with various payment terms (L/C, D/P, D/A)
- Supervised supply chains: quality testing, packaging, logistics

Property-Engineering Underwriter (full-time) *HCMC, Vietnam*
Global Insurance Corporation *Jul 2016 – Jul 2018*

- Underwrote 200+ insurance inquiries per month with 15+ different insurance products
- Wrote 5+reports per month: Revenue and Claim reports, Reports of Business efficiency
- Participated in the UI design project for the core system with an international partner's team

Certifications

Introduction to Large Language Models *Aug 2023*
Google

- Credential ID: 4627171
- Skill acquisition: Generative AI, Large Language Models, GPT

Microsoft Power BI Desktop for Business Intelligence *Jun 2023*
Maven Analytics via Udemy

- Credential ID: UC-303a5264-a7e9-431b-a000-eb32f597b5fc
- Skill acquisition: Power BI, Data visualization, Power Query, M & DAX coding

Unlock Excel VBA and Excel Macros *Aug 2023*
Leila Gharani via Udemy

- Credential ID: UC-0c7871ec-36b4-4731-b379-b661711a5aec
- Skill acquisition: Microsoft Excel Macros, VBA Excel, Microsoft Excel

Python for Data Analysis *Aug 2023*
Ryan Ahmed via Coursera

- Credential ID: KHXXASYJ223G
- Skill acquisition: Python, Pandas, NumPy

Research skills

Programming skills: QUARTO, Jupyter, Markdown for reproducible research (good), CRAN-R (expert), Stata (expert), Python (beginner), SPSS (good, but no longer used), LaTeX(good), Word-Excel-PowerPoint (expert), Power BI (good, but no longer used), SureyTogo (good, but no longer used), GitHub , WordPress, Blogger.

Experience with Datasets: European Social Survey (ESS), World Values Survey (WVS), Longitudinal Internet Studies for the Social Sciences (LISS) panel – Netherlands, Cross-National Online Survey (CRONOS), Luxembourg Income Study (LIS), Standardized World Income Inequality Database (SWIID), Penn World Table (PWT), World Bank Open Data (WDI), Global Database on Intergenerational Mobility (GDIM), Wisconsin Longitudinal Study (WLS), International Social Survey Programme (ISSP)

Quantitative methods: Randomized controlled trial, Difference in Difference, Regression Discontinuity Design, Time-series Analysis, Panel Data Analysis, Regularized Regression, Logistic Regression, Dimensionality Reduction, Clustering, Latent Variable Modelling, Causal Machine Learning, Generalized Random Forests, Social Network Analysis, Textual analysis, and Simulation.

Soft skills: Funding application, Time management, Project management, Teamwork, Critical thinking, Reflective writing, Philosophical reasoning, and Self-learning.

Languages: Vietnamese: Native; English: C1 (equivalent); Dutch: A1 (equivalent); Mandarin: A1 (equivalent)

Scholarly participation

Peer-review: Economic Change and Restructuring; Economics of Innovation and New Technology; Social Science Quarterly; Environment, Development and Sustainability; PLOS ONE; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; Applied Research in Quality of Life; Structural Change and Economic Dynamics

Academic membership: Society for the Advancement of Socioeconomics; Maynooth University Social Science Institute; Maynooth University academic group for Sustainability and Just Transition

Referees

Prof. Wim Groot, Professor of Health Economics and Evidence Based Education
Maastricht University and UNU-MERIT, ✉ w.groot@maastrichtuniversity.nl

Prof. Kristof De Witte, Vice-Dean and Professor of Education Economics
Faculty of Economics and Business, KU Leuven, ✉ kristof.dewitte@kuleuven.be

Prof. Jani Erola, Academy Professor, Director of INVEST Research Flagship Centre
Faculty of Social Science, University of Turku, ✉ jani.erola@utu.fi

Dr. Hannu Lehti, Academy Research Fellow, INVEST Research Flagship Centre
Faculty of Social Science, University of Turku, ✉ hpleht@utu.fi